

Winning the first conversation

90 minutes including practice · 28 screens

Edition 2026-09-14-als-live-v5

Your first-call reference

Use this after class alongside the presentation. Introduction, ALMS, channel choices, and examples are collected here. These fictional examples are adaptable wording, not scripts to recite.

The first conversation

Day 2: a Zillow Preferred lead arrives. What happens next?

We'll work from the lead alert through the first call and the next step you agree together.

The route through today's session

We'll follow Jordan's request, then try a few clearly marked variations.

- Receipt and first responseRead the request, choose the contact method, then submit a vote and a text.
 - The first conversationWatch the opening and discovery. Practice a follow-up with a partner.
 - Questions, closing, and a full callHandle a buyer's question, agree the plan, then rotate through a complete call.
- You answer on the current slide in your own session. Submit, then we'll discuss. The presenter advances everyone together.

The request tells you how to begin

Our example: Jordan asks to see 1234 Lane on Saturday morning.

Lead route	What you receive	What to check
Connection / contact agent	A question about a home, live or by FUB alert	The question and contact preference
Real-time touring	A tour alert using ShowingTime availability	The selected time and current arrangements
Standard tour	A tour request, live or by FUB alert	Whether the requested time is available

Jordan's is a standard tour request. Saturday morning is the buyer's preference. Property access still needs checking.

How will you contact the buyer?

Back to Jordan: an alert arrived, with no special contact instruction.

Already on a live call

Introduce yourself and begin.

FUB alert, no preference

Call within five minutes of receipt during TRU's 8 a.m.-8 p.m. operating window.

A specific instruction

Use the requested channel or callback time. Acknowledge a later callback by text now.

Jordan does not answer

Your personal text connects the missed call to the original request.

Hi Jordan, this is Sam with Northside Realty. I just called about your request to see 1234 Lane Saturday morning. I can talk at 4 or 6 today. Does either work?

While unanswered

Day one: aim for 3-4 personal touches, including at least 2 calls and 1 text. First week: 10 total including day one, mostly calls.

When Jordan replies

Continue from the reply and agree a plan. The unanswered-lead quota stops.

A requested callback changes the response

Variation: Maya is at work and asks for a call at five.

Hi Maya, I'm Sam with Northside Realty. I'll be calling at five about your request. Let me know if you have a question before then.

Text first for now

Help by text now. Offer a later call if useful.

An explicit no-call request

Honor it. Continue through the agreed channel.

Jordan answers. Where does the call go?

Introduce yourself first. ALMS gives the conversation a direction.

A

Appointment

Help with the requested visit.

L

Location

Learn where they want to be.

M

Motivation

Learn why it matters.

S

Summarize

Agree what happens next.

Location and motivation can come in either order. The buyer's answers guide the next question.

The opening answers “Who is this?”

Jordan requested Saturday morning. Use that information.

Agent “Hi Jordan, I'm Sam with Northside Realty, a featured partner with Zillow. I'm calling about your request to see 1234 Lane.”

Agent “I saw Saturday morning. I'll check access for that time. Would morning still work for you?”

Jordan “Yes, morning works.”

No time selected? Offer two times you can actually make. Property access still needs confirmation.

The appointment opens a conversation

Before asking about the search, explain why the questions help.

Agent “Do you have a few minutes so I can learn what you're looking for and make our time together useful?”

Jordan “Sure. We're already in town.”

Agent “What's changing where you live now?”

Jordan “We rent an apartment. We'd like outdoor space.”

If they have only a minute, keep it brief. Handle the request and agreed next action without forcing a full interview.

“Outdoor space” needs a follow-up

The feature becomes useful when you understand its purpose.

Agent “What would you like to do with that space?”

Jordan “I'd like a vegetable garden.”

Agent “What would you need from the space for that?”

Jordan “Somewhere sunny, with room for raised beds.”

Now the search has a reason: usable garden space. A large yard alone may not solve it.

What if the buyer only wants an answer?

Variation: the buyer declines a tour and asks about the roof.

Agent “Of course. What would you like to know?”

Buyer "How old is the roof?"

Agent "I'll check that. Can I ask what concerns you about it?"

Buyer "I'm worried about taking on repairs."

Bring the answer back. Explain how a viewing could help them decide. If they still decline, agree how to return the information.

When the buyer asks about a lender

Variation: "Should I talk to a lender before we look?"

Agent "A lender can help you understand your options. What are you hoping to work out before we look?"

Buyer "I don't know what payment I'd be comfortable with."

Agent "That's useful to work through. I can help connect you with a lender to discuss those numbers."

Help with the concern. Do not turn the showing request into a demand for preapproval.

"Are you the listing agent?"

The buyer needs a clear answer about your role.

I'm not the listing agent. I help buyers and can coordinate with the listing side. What would you like to know?

If they prefer the listing agent, offer to help with that connection. Respect their choice.

The home is under contract

Separate variation: you learn this during the first inquiry. No showing is confirmed.

Agent "The home is under contract. I can check whether a viewing is still possible. What drew you to it?"

Buyer "The yard. I want room for a garden."

Agent "I can also research homes with useful garden space. Would that help?"

State what you know. Keep access and unresearched alternatives conditional.

The plan should use what Jordan told you

Back to the original call. Jordan wants sunny space for raised beds.

Agent "Would it help to compare another home with usable garden space while we're out?"

Jordan "Yes, that would help."

Agent "Saturday morning is your preference. I'll check access to 1234 Lane and research a comparison with garden space. I'll text you the details after I hear back. Is that right?"

Jordan "Yes. Text is good."

The whole call: opening and discovery

Demonstration. Follow the conversation rather than naming each step.

Sam "Hi Jordan, I'm Sam with Northside Realty, a featured partner with Zillow. I'm calling about 1234 Lane. I saw Saturday morning. Would that still work? I'll check access."

Jordan "Yes, morning works."

Sam "Have you got a few minutes so I can make our time useful?"

Jordan "Sure."

Sam "What's changing where you live now?"

Jordan "We rent in town. We'd like outdoor space."

The same call: discovery and agreement

Continue without restarting the conversation.

Sam "What would you like to do with that space?"

Jordan "A vegetable garden. I need sun and room for raised beds."

Sam "Would comparing another home with garden space help?"

Jordan "Yes."

Sam "Saturday morning is your preference. I'll check access and research that comparison, then text the details. Does that work?"

Jordan "Yes, text is good."

The record should match the call

Day 1 showed where to save the work. Here is what Jordan's call gives you.

Conversation note

Rents locally. Wants sunny space for raised beds. Prefers Saturday morning. Open to a comparison home. Text agreed.

Pending action

Check access to 1234 Lane and research a useful comparison.

Task and next contact

Set a task for the promised work. Text the details after the access answer, as agreed.

Saturday morning remains requested until access is confirmed. Do not record a completed showing or an agreement the buyer did not make.

Your first-call reference

Read the request. Help with it. Agree what happens next.

Before contact

Check the lead route, home, requested time, and contact preference.

When connected

Introduce yourself. Offer the appointment early. Ask permission, then follow the buyer's answers about location and motivation.

Before finishing

Summarize priorities, pending checks, and the agreed next action. Save the note and task.

Open the examples and first-call reference

Practice notes

Use fictional details. Write before the example, practice aloud, and retry one specific part after feedback. During a live session, submit through your own login; this printable worksheet is a backup and does not submit for you. The form follows the presenter. Submit before the class moves on, or ask the presenter to return to the question.

Your turn: requested or confirmed?

Another standard tour lead asks for 5 p.m. Access is unconfirmed. What do you do?

- Confirm 5 p.m. now and check access afterward.
- Acknowledge 5 p.m. and verify property access.
- Ask for a new time before checking the requested one.

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Your turn: acknowledge Maya

Maya's alert arrives at 2 p.m. and asks for a 5 p.m. call. Write your acknowledgment.

What would you text Maya now?

Your turn: no time was selected

Practice variation: Jordan asked to see 1234 Lane but selected no time. How would you begin?

- Ask about budget and preapproval before offering a time.
- Explain the buying process before discussing the visit.
- Introduce yourself and offer workable showing times.

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Write your introduction and early appointment invitation.

Partner practice: what does “more space” mean?

Practice variation: your buyer says, “We need more space.” Learn what that means, then switch roles.

What would you ask next, and what would that help you understand?

What did your partner suggest, and how did your retry change?

Observe the assigned learner and round:

- Ask permission before discovery
- Ask a follow-up based on the buyer’s actual answer

Observer / learner / round / one correction / retry:

Your turn: a financing question

The buyer asks, “Should I talk to a lender before we look?” What is the best response?

- Ask what they need to work out, then offer relevant lender help.
- Save the financing question for the showing and move on.
- Ask for a preapproval letter before scheduling the showing.

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Your turn: a home under contract

Variation: the home is under contract. The buyer wants garden space. What do you say next?

Write your response and a useful next step.

Your turn: the agreed next step

Jordan wants garden space, prefers Saturday morning, accepts a comparison home, and agrees to text. Access is pending.

Write the summary and next step you would say aloud.

Group practice: the complete first call

Trios rotate through agent, buyer, and observer. Everyone speaks.

What did you learn about the buyer?

What will you improve?

What changed when you tried it again?

Observe the assigned learner and round:

- Clear name, brokerage, Zillow connection and purpose
- Useful early appointment invitation that respects the request
- Permission, relevant location/motivation questions and a follow-up
- Accurate priorities, commitments and unresolved checks
- Responds to the buyer's actual preference and circumstances

Observer / learner / round / one correction / retry:

Your turn: explain the next lead

Without looking back, explain the first-call decisions in your own words.

What does ALMS stand for, and why does the appointment come early?

What changes when the buyer asks for a later call or text first?

Give one follow-up question that turns a feature into a reason.

Buyer practice cards

Jordan • a garden

I'd like to see 1234 Lane Saturday morning. The yard caught my eye.

Buyer: you rent locally and want sun and room for raised beds. Reveal those details after relevant questions. You are open to a comparison home. Access remains unconfirmed.

Maya • text first

I'm at work. Please text me now; I can talk at five.

Begin with the text exchange, then fast-forward to the agreed call. Buyer: a shorter commute matters; reveal it when asked. Honor the contact preference and agree the later conversation.

Alex • questions first

I only wanted to know about the roof. I'm not ready to book a showing.

Buyer: maintenance costs concern you. Reveal this after a relevant question. Decline the next invitation too. Agent should help with the question and agree how to return verified information.

What each signal means

Connection status is separate from participation. A submitted answer is separate from a completed action. A record check is separate from writing quality. Record who observed a speaking turn and who reviewed it; a peer observation or self-check is not coach sign-off. Practice readiness, quiz certification, and activation remain separate.

After the workshop

Live session: closing the session creates assignments for recall within 24 hours, a fresh case in three days, and coach review in seven days. The session creator owns follow-up across the selected teams unless a different authorized coach was selected. Confirm the displayed session timezone. Due and overdue work appears in Rep; the daily digest links to work due or awaiting review.

Self-paced study: arrange those same checks with a coach. If there has been no relevant client opportunity, use a new fictional case and mark real-work application as not yet observed.

Keep the first attempt and correction. A useful follow-up asks whether the agent can apply the skill in another case.

References

- Your coach and approved team workflow.